Precautions:

Observe the skin carefully during and after the treatment. The client and the therapist must use protective goggles during the treatment to shut out reflected harmful rays.

3.3 Sitz bath (hip bath)

Sitz bath is a method of applying heat using tepid or hot water to the pelvic or rectal area by sitting in a tub. The client is usually immersed from the mid thigh to the iliac crest. The temperature of the water is 110-115 degree F and the duration of the bath is 15 to 30 minutes.

Purpose:

1. To relieve congestion of the pelvic organs e.g. in dysmenorrhoea.
2. To relieve pain following cystoscopy.
3. To reduce inflammation.
4. To promote drainage of rectal abscess and haemorrhoids.

Solutions Used:

1. Potassium permanganate solution 1:5000
2. Boric acid 1 dram to 1 pint.
3. Eusol solution.

Contraindications:

1. Pregnancy.
2. Menstruation.
3. Renal Inflammation.
4. Increased irritability of the genital organs.

Procedure:

1. Test the water in the bath tub with a thermometer before the client is allowed to enter into the water.
2. Assist the client to the tub or into the sitz bath and position properly.
3. Wrap a blanket around the shoulders to prevent exposure and chilling.
4. Monitor the client closely for sign of weakness and fatigue and discontinue the bath if faintness, pallor, rapid pulse or nausea occurs.
5. Check the temperature of the water in between and keep it at the desired temperature by adding hot water.
6. Do not leave the client alone in the bath tub.
7. When the bath is completed, assist the client to come out of the bath and dry well.
8. If the client complaints of fainting or weakness, assist him out of the bath.
9. The client may feel sleepy due to the sedative effect of the sitz bath, so care should be taken to prevent falling.
10. Record the procedure.

Practical 3.indd 283 07/05/18 2:22 PM